3. Right Type of Supplies: Each of the stationery is procured according to the needs of an office. For efficient performance of office work the employees should be provided with right type of stationeries.

Do You Know?

Invention of the Ball Point Pen

- The first patent for a ball point pen was issued on 30th October 1888 to John J Loud. He was attempting in making a writing instrument that would be able to write "on rough surfaces – such as wood, coarse wrapping-paper and other articles" on which the fountain pen could not write. The first commercially modern ball point pen was patented by Argentinian – Hungarian Inventor, Laszlo Biro in 1938.
- Ball point pens are made of metals, plastic and some other chemicals. When they were first made for a ball, the point was used steel. Today it uses textured tungsten carbide because it is resistant to deforming. The point that holds the ball is made of brass-alloy of copper and zinc.

4.2. Factors to be Considered for Selecting Office Stationery:

The office manager has to decide about the quality, types, and needs of stationery. Besides, the following points have to be considered while deciding the stationery.

1. **Standard:** Separate standard is followed for each type of stationery. There is no link of standard with cost. Only utility is taken into account while deciding the standard.

2. **Suitability:** The stationery should be capable of satisfying the needs of the office and well suited for the purpose for which they are purchased.

3. **Cost:** Clerical operations cannot be carried out in the absence of stationery. Even though, the cost of stationery should not exceed 40% to 50% of the non-salary expenditure.

4. **Goodwill:** The letters must give a good impression to the recipient. They create goodwill for the firm.

5. **Durability:** Cheaper quality stationery has a shorter life. The papers are kept for long period and used as documentary evidence. Hence, superior quality stationery should be used for important matters.

6. **Preservation:** The carbon copy of the letter is preserved for future reference. Hence, the letter appears on the carbon.

7. **Performance:** A specified brand of stationery has to be used continuously until the stage of availability of satisfaction. If not so, it has to be substituted by another brand.

8. **Quality:** Stationery has short life if ordinary quality is purchased. The

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